

8. **Account data:** Review whether payment, email or application telemetry links usage to you.
9. **Cancellation:** Check data-retention and account-deletion procedures.

A kill switch is intended to block network traffic if the VPN tunnel fails. Test it rather than assuming it works: connect to the VPN, begin a harmless download, disconnect the VPN manually and observe whether the connection stops. Then compare your visible IP address and DNS resolution before and after connection. Repeat after major updates.

Do not obsess over “multi-hop” as a magic upgrade. Sending traffic through two provider-controlled servers may reduce reliance on one machine, but the same company may still control both ends.

India reality check on VPN

CERT-In’s cybersecurity directions require covered service providers, intermediaries, data centres, body corporates and government organisations to enable ICT-system logs and keep them for a rolling 180 days. They also require data centres, VPS, cloud and consumer VPN service providers to register specified customer details – including validated names, hire periods, allotted IP addresses, onboarding email and IP data, purpose, address and contact information – and retain them for five years or longer after cancellation where law requires.

CERT-In’s FAQ clarifies that the VPN provision applies to providers offering internet-proxy-like VPN services to general users, not enterprise or corporate VPNs. It also says a provider serving users in India has obligations under the directions, while logs may be stored outside India if they can be produced to CERT-In within a reasonable time.

This does not mean every VPN automatically records every webpage. It means readers must not assume that a global “no

logs” slogan describes the provider’s Indian operations, legal obligations or customer records. Check whether the company has Indian servers, offers services to Indian users, withdrew infrastructure, changed terms or explains how it complies. Laws, interpretations and services can change; verify the position when subscribing.

Tor separates knowledge across relays

Tor Browser sends browser traffic through a circuit of volunteer-operated relays. The entry relay sees your IP address but not the final destination. The exit relay connects to the destination but ordinarily does not know your original IP address. The website sees the exit relay’s address. This distributed design avoids placing the complete route with one commercial provider.

Tor Browser also standardises browser behaviour to reduce fingerprinting. Do not add extensions, alter window behaviour unnecessarily or open downloaded documents in external applications while online. Tor warns that external documents may fetch internet resources outside Tor and expose the ordinary IP address. It also warns against torrenting because torrent applications may bypass proxy settings or reveal IP information.

Use Tor Browser safely

1. Download Tor Browser only from the Tor Project.
2. Verify the website and keep the browser updated.
3. Choose Connect unless the network blocks Tor.
4. Use the built-in browser; do not configure an ordinary browser manually.
5. Keep HTTPS-Only Mode enabled.
6. Do not install extra extensions or plugins.
7. Avoid logging into personal accounts during an anonymous activity.

